forward, with their headquarters located at Fazilka and Bhikiwind respectively. The Indian plan was for each of these three divisions to advance to the Ichhogil Canal to exert pressure on Lahore and Pakistan's heartland and thus deter Pakistan from further escalation. Pakistan responded by placing its armed forces on 12 hours' notice, minelaying along the border and preparing the bridges over the Ichhogil Canal for demolition. While these developments were taking place, the British prime minister, Harold Wilson, had initiated a diplomatic effort to return to the status quo and negotiations to resolve the Rann of Kutch issue . As a result of this outreach, hostilities in the Rann of Kutch ended on 1 July 1965.

The performance of the Indian Army during this stand-off was unsatisfactory. There was no higher plan to meet the Pakistani attack, nor any preparation for the operations in the sector, with local commanders choosing their own objectives. The Indian Army's ineptitude was matched by that of the Pakistan Army as it had no plan to test the Indian Army's capabilities or to draw in Indian troops from other sectors. The flare-up ended with no major gains accrued to either side; it was a victory of sorts for the Pakistan Army, but with the wrong lesson – that it could gain an easy win in Kashmir.